

Group Lecture Self-Evaluation Paper Assignment

Raymond Wagoner

School of Behavioral Sciences, Liberty University

Author Note

Raymond Wagoner

I have no known conflict of interest to disclose.

Correspondence concerning this article should be addressed to Raymond Wagoner.

Email: rdwagoner1@liberty.edu

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Teaching has been a mixed bag for me in the past. Emotionally it has been mixed because I love it but don't know if I'm good at it. Experientially it has been a mixed bag because I am a bit stubborn and don't always like strict processes but know they help me learn how to teach better. The experience I had in the 512 group course was similar. I enjoyed the process but wasn't sure the students learned what they needed to or enjoyed the experience themselves. The following is my processing of that experience.

Summary of Evaluation

What feedback did you receive from the COUC 512 instructor?

In the time we had after I presented my lecture, Dr. Ford was very complementary. She stated that the lecture was appropriate and helpful. She also stated that the use of my personality and style were additions to the presentation. When I asked her what I could improve upon, she explained that a time proceeding the lecture for questions and processing of the material could have been more useful in solidifying the content for the students. The evaluation form was equally as complimentary. Dr. Ford stated that the presentation was "challenging toward a deeper understanding of the principles". I was encouraged in the preparation and the thoughtfulness of the presentation through analogy and creativity.

What items did you excel at and what items do you need to improve?

Dr. Ford indicated that I excelled at the art of teaching. My use of story and metaphor was called illustrative and additive. According to the evaluation form, I excelled at all aspects of the lecture. Dr. Ford strongly agreed that the presentation was purposeful and appropriate for the class and the learning level of the students. I personally feel that I could have improved my connection to the class with more reflective questions. I felt pressed for time and anxiously

thought that the students had been slow to respond to questions all week. Dr. Ford assured me that questions would have been answered in time to give the full lecture, however. So, I learned that, when the class is mine to manage the time, I will interact more with additional questions for the class. I had more reflective questions in my original plan but chose to shift to rhetorical questions. Although this did not take away from the creativity and effective nature of the presentation, I could have encouraged more participation.

Personal Learning & Integration

What did you learn from your teaching experience and the feedback from your evaluation?

Overall, my experience was gratifying. I learned that teaching may be more of a gift and desire than I allow for. I learned that having both the art and science of a lecture prepared as much as possible is key to disseminating the information in a manner that can be received by students. Again, I do not gravitate toward the science of teaching, but I understand and agree that pedagogy is vital to learning outcomes.

From the evaluation I learned that I have grown through 747 and other courses where a lesson plan and lecture are requirements. I did find that the students enjoyed the experience more than I expected. This is an area I have grown in. That is, being aware of the level of learning and the attention span of the students. I made an educated guess at the academic nature of the material for this lecture, but it seems to have been on target. I still need to grow in determining the best content for my students. I could have the opportunity in the near future to teach at the undergraduate level and will need to collaborate with tenured professors to ensure I am neither too low nor too high with content expectations.

How will you incorporate what you have learned into your future career as a counselor educator?

These experiences are fabulous in vivo rehearsals. Similar to role play in skills work, they allow me to help others in real life, but not fear complete disaster for those I am leading. I will certainly incorporate the lesson plan and presentation science of this course in the future. Having a manuscript for the first year of teaching will remove a lot of pressure in the moment of class. My biggest detriment to a Ph.D. experience is a broadened vocabulary. This is both a blessing and a curse as I can't always remember those big words, nor do I need to use them always. Having appropriate language that I can read (not in a boring fashion but as reminders) will allow me to focus more on the student's reactions and decerning there level of understanding.

I appreciate the opportunity and the practice and pray it all leads to being helpful to student in the future.